

UX DESIGN SUPPORT DOCUMENT – CODECAMPUS

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN A

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1. Introduction

This document explains how the final login/register, landing and about us design for CodeCampus is supported by our group's UX research, how it applies Jakob's Law, and how it satisfies the client's brief.

The client's brief was to create a new login/register system that is generic, flexible and smart enough to be reused not only on the main site but also on future sister sites. CodeCampus is an online platform that sells coding lessons across eight languages and technologies: Python, C++, PostgreSQL, Java, TypeScript, HTML, CSS and ReactJS. Because the audience is developers and aspiring developers, the login experience also needed to feel credible and comfortable to a technically literate user base.

To meet this brief, our group ran three short UEQ-based evaluations on Coursera, Udemy and Khan Academy, three established online learning platforms, and used the patterns that emerged to guide our own design decisions rather than designing from a blank page (Schrepp, Hinderks and Thomaschewski, 2017).

2. Persona

Name: Thabo M: the Career-Switching Builder

Quote: *"I'd started a dozen Python courses and finished none of them. This is the first one where I actually built something I use."*

Photo: *[insert persona photo here]*

Key goal: Learn to write real, working code he can point to, rather than collect another unfinished certificate.

- Stated as an outcome, not a feature, and kept to one sentence.
- Test: could this goal exist without CodeCampus? Yes, but reaching it without a structured, project-based platform is exactly where his last two attempts stalled.

Behaviour

- **Motivation:** wants a shipped project he can point to, more than a badge or certificate.
- **Habits:** studies in short, irregular bursts between work and job hunting, and drops any course that front-loads theory before he gets to build something.

Must do / Mustn't do

- **Must:** save his progress automatically so a short session never feels wasted.
- **Must:** get him to something buildable within his first sitting.
- **Mustn't:** require account creation before he can browse the course catalogue or read the About Us page.
- **Mustn't:** ask for more than the essentials (email, password, name) at sign-up. Anything else can wait until he's already invested.

These must/mustn't rules are what Section 6's login guidelines and Section 8's design walkthrough are built to satisfy.

3. Task Model

Goal: Create a CodeCampus account and reach the first lesson of a chosen language track.

Order of tasks

- Land on the homepage or a course page
- Decide to start ("Start your first build" / "Create your account")
- Fill in the registration form
- Submit and land on the dashboard / first lesson

User behaviour

- **Direct connection:** registering itself is a low-thought, transactional step. By the time Thabo reaches the form, he has already decided to sign up, so the form should not introduce new decisions.
- **Controlled evaluation:** happens earlier, on the landing page and catalogue, where he compares languages, price, and free vs paid tracks.
- **Complex evaluation:** should rarely happen at registration. If Thabo hesitates over which sign-up option to use, that's a sign the form has introduced too much choice.

Content requirements: the form needs to show exactly what is required (email, password, display name) and nothing more. Showing the password rule upfront, rather than only after a failed submit, avoids a dead-end moment.

Emotional needs: reassurance that signing up is quick, reversible and low-risk, with no hidden requirement to enter payment details just to create an account.

Existing barriers: long, unclear forms are what caused Thabo to abandon platforms before. This matches what our own research found. Coursera's login page scored lowest on Efficient across our whole benchmark, for exactly this kind of reason.

Suggested solution: a single-column form limited to three fields, with the password rule shown upfront rather than only appearing after an error.

4. User Journey

Scenario: Thabo decides to give coding another real try after his last two attempts stalled out.

DISCOVER

- **Action:** Sees a testimonial or referral, opens the CodeCampus homepage, skims the hero section and course cards.

- **Mindset / emotion:** Skeptical, guarded. “Is this going to be another tutorial graveyard?”

EXPLORE

- **Action:** Browses the catalogue, opens the About Us page.
- **Mindset / emotion:** Cautiously reassured by the mission statement and real numbers rather than generic marketing copy. “Okay, this actually looks like it's for building things.”

REGISTER

- **Action:** Clicks “Start your first build,” fills in the minimal registration form, submits.
- **Mindset / emotion:** Brief friction right before submitting, quick relief once it goes through with no surprise steps. “That was fast.”

BUILD

- **Action:** Lands on the dashboard, opens the first lesson.
- **Mindset / emotion:** Motivated, ready to commit real time. “Alright, let's ship something.”

Opportunities: a short, visible preview of what the first lesson looks like before registering could lower the anxiety at the Register phase even further.

Internal ownership + metrics: Frontend keeps registration to three fields on one screen; Content ensures the first lesson has a visible, completable milestone within the first sitting.

This journey shows Thabo's biggest point of friction isn't the login form itself, it's the moment right before he commits to it. That lines up with what our Coursera evaluation found: efficiency drops when a step feels uncertain, not necessarily when it's objectively long.

5. Synthesis of UX Research

The three evaluations agreed on one central pattern: login pages score best when they are predictable, and landing pages score best when they are allowed to have personality.

On all three sites, Innovative or Conventional – Innovative was either the lowest or one of the lowest scoring criteria on the login page (Khan Academy 5.7, Udemy 5.3, Coursera 4.3), while Easy to Use, Clarity or Efficient scored highest on that same page in every report. In other words, the login flow is where users most want a platform to behave like every other platform they have used before, and they reward that sameness with higher usability scores.

The landing page told a different story. Udemy's landing page scored its highest mark on Boring – Exciting (6.7), and Coursera's landing page scored its highest marks on Innovative and Interesting (5.3 each). This suggests that once users are past the login barrier, they are more willing to engage with a richer, more expressive design. Coursera's

data also showed a real cost to that richness: its landing page scored lowest on Efficient (4.3), meaning a busier landing page needs a clear way for users to still get where they are going quickly.

The about us page came through as the page most at risk of being forgettable. Coursera's about us scores sat consistently in the middle across every criterion, while Udemy's about us page, which leans on mission-driven language and real statistics about its instructors and learners, scored much higher on Interesting (6.7). This tells us that an about us page needs a deliberate identity, not just filler copy.

6. Design Guidelines

These are the guidelines drawn from the synthesis above and applied directly to CodeCampus.

#	Guideline	Site evidence
1	Keep the login/register form conventional and minimal: email, password, clearly labelled buttons, standard field order.	Khan Academy (Easy to Use 6.3, Clarity 6.0 on Login), Udemy (Efficient 6.0 on Login), Coursera (Efficient 5.3 on Login, its highest score)
2	Do not spend 'innovation budget' on the login form. Save creative or novel touches for the landing and about us pages instead.	Innovative was the lowest or near-lowest criterion on the login page across all three sites (Khan 5.7, Udemy 5.3, Coursera 4.3)
3	Offer social login (e.g. GitHub, Google) as a supplementary option, not the only path, and defer non-essential fields to a later onboarding step.	Udemy's login only asks for email or social login at first, with registration details collected afterwards
4	Give the landing page room to be visually rich and give it a clear identity, since users are more tolerant of exploration there.	Udemy's landing page scored highest on Boring – Exciting (6.7); Coursera's landing page scored highest on Innovative and Interesting (5.3 each)
5	Balance that visual richness with a clear primary call to action so exploration does not come at the cost of perceived efficiency.	Coursera's landing page scored lowest on Efficient (4.3), the weakest score across its whole report
6	Give the about us page a genuine identity (mission statement, real numbers, instructor stories) rather than treating it as a generic filler page.	Coursera's about us page scored consistently mid-range with no standout; Udemy's about us page scored highest on Interesting (6.7) by leaning

#	Guideline	Site evidence
		into mission-driven language and stats
7	Keep the core interaction pattern (field order, button placement, error handling) identical across every sister site, and only vary branding and colour.	Direct requirement from the client statement: a system 'generic/flexible/smart enough' for the main site and future sister sites

7. Jakob's Law Application

Jakob's Law states that users spend most of their time on other websites, so they will transfer the expectations they have built up on those sites to yours. When a design breaks convention without good reason, it forces users to slow down and relearn something, which increases cognitive load and frustration, and this is exactly what our login page data captured (Laws of UX, n.d.).

CodeCampus applies this principle most directly on the login/register page. We deliberately reused the most familiar login pattern found across all three benchmarked sites: a centred form with email and password fields, clearly labelled primary and secondary buttons, and a supplementary 'Continue with GitHub' social login option, which is a familiar choice specifically for a developer audience rather than a generic one. Registration only asks for the essentials up front (email, password, display name), with anything else pushed to onboarding, mirroring the low-friction pattern we saw on Udemy.

Where CodeCampus intentionally departs from strict sameness is on the landing and about us pages, where our research showed users reward a platform for having its own voice. The trade-off our data pointed to, familiarity on login versus personality on landing and about us, is the guiding logic behind every decision below.

8. Design Walkthrough

8.1 Login/Register Page

Feature: Centred single-column form with email, password and a GitHub social login option

Guideline: 1, 2, 3 (Section 6)

Jakob's Law application: this mirrors the exact structure that scored highest for Easy to Use and Clarity across all three benchmark sites. No unconventional field order, no extra steps before a returning user can log in.

Feature: Registration limited to email, password and display name, with course preferences and other details collected after first login

Guideline: 3

Jakob's Law application: matches Udemy's low-friction registration pattern, which participants rated as efficient specifically because it did not front-load unnecessary fields.

CodeCamp

Home Courses About

Log in Sign up

// LEARN BY SHIPPING

"I'd started a dozen Python courses and finished none of them. This is the first one where I actually built something I use."

— Thabo M., Python track

Welcome back

Log in Sign up

Continue with GitHub

OR CONTINUE WITH EMAIL

Email

Password

Forgot password?

Log in

CodeCamp

Home Courses About

Log in Sign up

// LEARN BY SHIPPING

"I'd started a dozen Python courses and finished none of them. This is the first one where I actually built something I use."

— Thabo M., Python track

Start building

Log in Sign up

Continue with GitHub

OR CONTINUE WITH EMAIL

Full name

Email

Password

Use at least 8 characters.

Create account

8.2 Landing Page

Feature: Hero section showcasing the eight languages/technologies taught (Python, C++, PostgreSQL, Java, TypeScript, HTML, CSS, ReactJS) with course cards and a single, clearly visible 'Get Started' call to action

Guideline: 4, 5

Jakob's Law application: gives the page the visual richness that Udemy and Coursera's landing pages were rewarded for, while the single primary call to action protects the Efficient score that Coursera's landing page lost by being too busy.

◆ CodeCampus

Home Courses About

Log in

Sign up

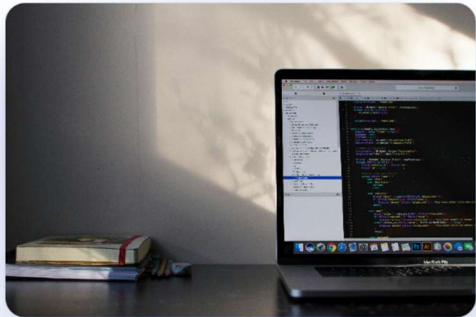
// LEARN BY SHIPPING

Stop watching tutorials. Start building using TypeScript.

CodeCampus teaches real programming languages the only way that sticks: you build a real, working thing in every course - not a slide deck about one.

Start your first build

Browse courses



◆ CodeCampus

Home Courses About

Log in

Sign up

8
Hands-on courses

7
Skill tracks

48
Hours of building

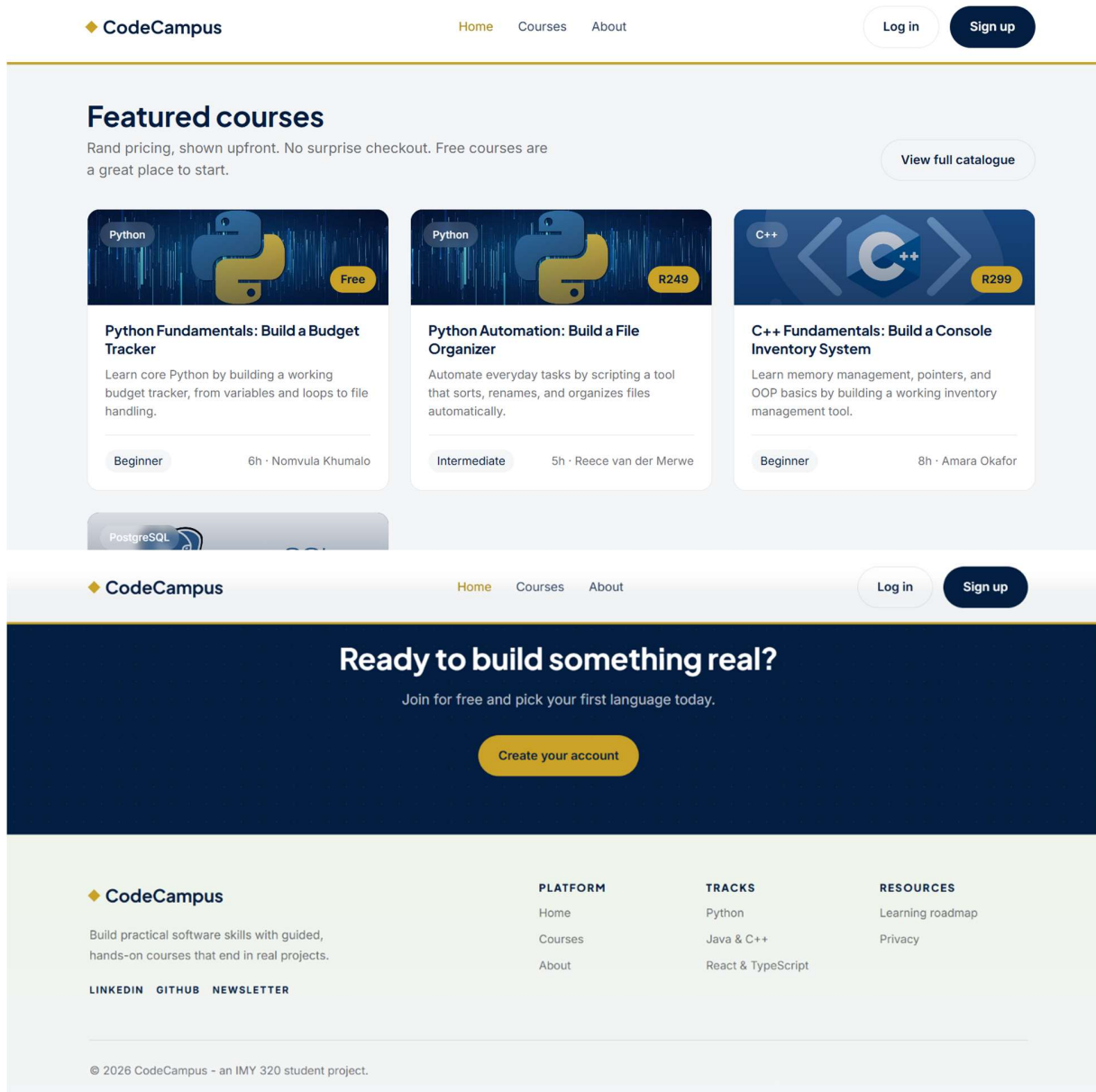
2
Free to start

WHY CODECAMPUS

01
Project-first, always
Every course ends with something you shipped. A working application, bot, or game - not just a certificate.

02
Bite-sized, self-paced
Pick up a module on a lunch break or block out a weekend. Your progress is saved automatically.

03
Built for real developers
No fluff, no filler modules. Instructors are working engineers who write the same code they teach.

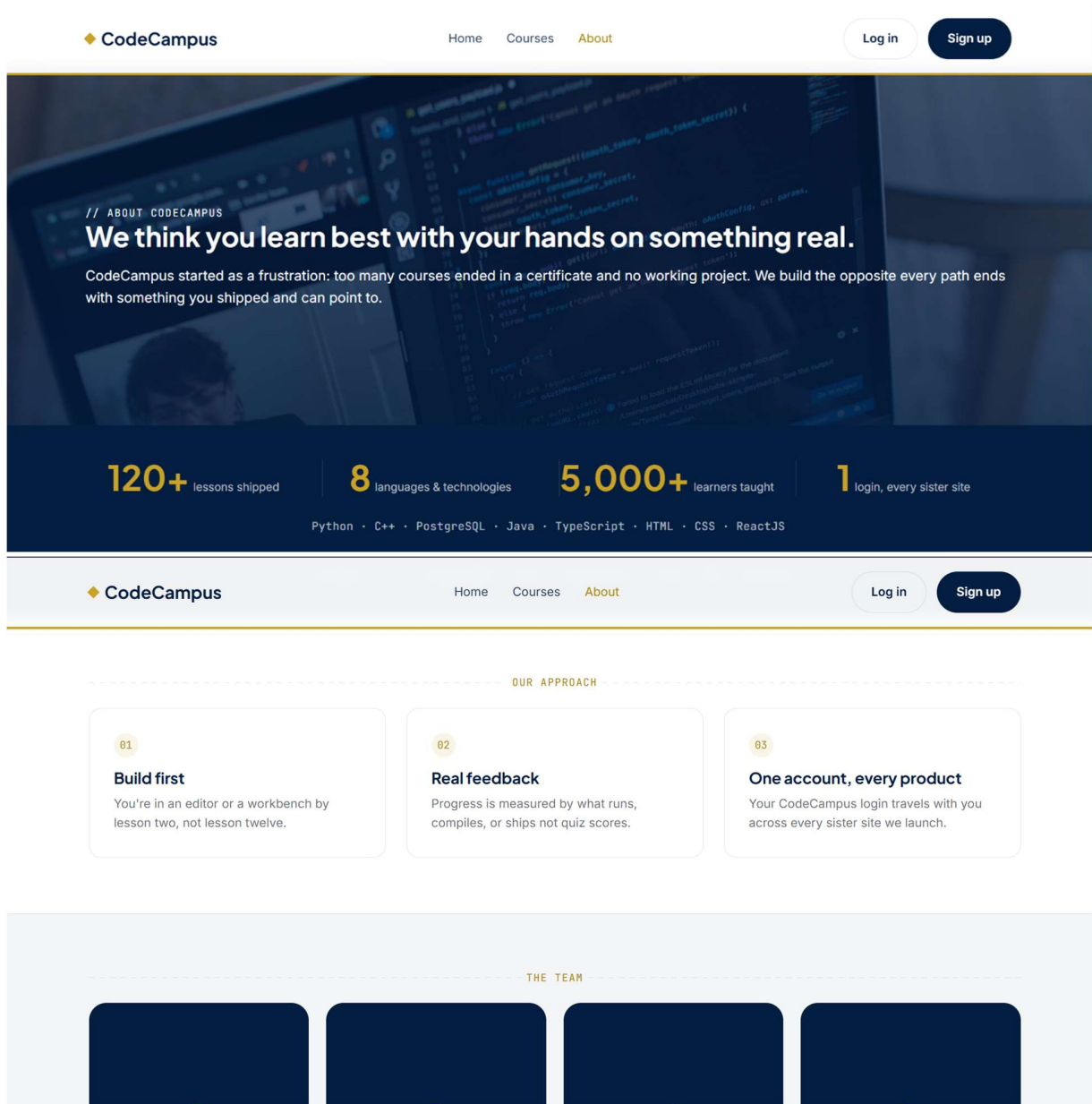


8.3 About Us Page

Feature: Mission statement focused on practical, job-ready coding skills, supported by real figures (e.g. number of lessons, languages covered) and short instructor profiles

Guideline: 6

Jakob's Law application: follows Udemy's approach of using mission language and concrete statistics rather than generic corporate copy, which is what separated its high Interesting score from Coursera's mid-range one.



9. How the Design Satisfies the Client's Need

The client asked for a login system generic and flexible enough to work on CodeCampus's main site and on future sister sites. This is addressed structurally, not just visually:

- The login/register form is built as a single reusable component. Field order, validation behaviour, button placement and error handling stay identical everywhere it is used.
- Branding (logo, colour palette, imagery) is the only thing that changes between the main site and any sister site, kept in a separate theme layer rather than hard-coded into the login component itself.

- Social login is treated as an optional, swappable extra rather than a hard dependency, so a sister site could add or drop a provider without touching the core form.
- Because the core login pattern already matches what users expect from any learning platform, a returning CodeCampus user logging into a sister site for the first time still recognises the flow immediately, which is the practical outcome of applying Jakob's Law to a multi-site product.

10. Conclusion

Across Coursera, Udemy and Khan Academy, the same pattern held: users reward familiarity on the login page and personality on the landing and about us pages. CodeCampus's design follows that pattern directly, using a deliberately conventional login/register flow so returning developers can get in with no friction, while giving the landing and about us pages room to reflect what CodeCampus actually teaches. Because the login component's structure is kept separate from its branding, the same design can be reused across future sister sites without asking users to relearn anything, which is exactly what the client asked for.

References

Laws of UX, n.d. Jakob's Law. Available at: <https://lawsofux.com/jakobs-law/> [Accessed 8 August 2026].

Schrepp, M., Hinderks, A. and Thomaschewski, J., 2017. Design and evaluation of a short version of the User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S). *International Journal of Interactive Multimedia and Artificial Intelligence*, 4(6), pp.103–108.